

Shayan Zafar Ahmad

Senior Software Engineering Manager · Richmond Hill, ON · shayan.zafar.ahmad@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/shayan-zafar-ahmad-85351023 · github.com/ShayanZafar · shayanzafar.github.io

SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 7 years managing software teams and team leads across healthcare, sports betting, retail, and HCM, and 14 years building systems hands-on. Scaled distributed teams across four global time zones; redesigned SDLC and CI/CD for predictable delivery; drove monolith-to-microservices migrations on event-driven Kafka platforms; led engineering-wide adoption of AI development tooling. Partners with executives on roadmaps and capacity planning; hands-on in C#, T-SQL, and TypeScript on Azure.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineering Manager

Sep 2024 – Present

MitraTech · Remote (Canada)

- Manage 12 engineers across two distributed teams spanning India, US East/West, and Mexico; established a cross-time-zone technical sync that reduced delivery uncertainty and improved code quality.
- Redesigned the SDLC around technical planning and best-practice CI/CD, front-loading engineering risk and increasing delivery predictability.
- Led engineering-wide adoption of AI-assisted development: procured licensing, integrated Devin for code scanning and metrics, set team guardrails and best practices, and built PoCs for tech-debt and feature validation with Copilot and Devin.
- Reduced tooling spend through vendor and licence audits, eliminating redundant licences and third-party tool misuse.
- Built a hiring process centred on code review, coding exercises, and technical design; created an onboarding framework for new developers.
- Prioritized and reduced security technical debt using Snyk reporting, pen-test findings, dependency upgrades, and secure coding practices.
- Introduced a consistent monthly release cycle, decoupling a conflicting multi-team release cadence.
- Added application monitoring with Datadog and Application Insights; improved the git branching strategy to shorten delivery time.
- Hands-on in C#, T-SQL, and TypeScript; lead design discussions, architecture decisions, and code reviews.

Software Engineering Manager, Sportsbook APIs

Sep 2022 – Sep 2024

DraftKings · Remote (Canada)

- Managed a team of 7 engineers in the Sportsbook division; owned hiring, performance, 1:1s, and career growth, promoting an intermediate developer to senior and a lead developer to manager.
- Led the migration of a legacy monolithic betting application to DDD-based, event-driven microservices streaming real-time Kafka sports data to sportsbook.draftkings.com.
- Delivered a separate real-time odds-feed API for third-party B2B partners, including technical design and a C# PoC client used to validate partner documentation.
- Owned the team roadmap, backlog, and timelines in JIRA; led capacity planning and initiative costing with executives; tracked delivery health through velocity, burndown, and churn metrics.
- Authored the technical plan for an internal real-time telemetry application monitoring Kafka systems; designed ETL microservices over Kafka topics.
- Extended the SDLC with isolated load and performance testing; upgraded all microservices to the latest .NET release and dependencies.
- Monitored application health with Datadog, ELK, and Grafana.

Software Engineering Manager

Jan 2022 – Sep 2022

Staples Canada · Ontario, Canada

- Managed technical staff; transitioned the team from project-based to team-based delivery and established a reliable software delivery process.
- Recruited a team lead, senior developers, and QA for new external teams; planned and costed initiatives with executives.
- Maintained .NET C# middleware and APIs on Azure with Docker and Kubernetes DevOps pipelines.
- Drove security compliance through training and oversight of security measures across codebases and databases; documented system architecture.

Software Development Team Lead

May 2021 – Jan 2022

LifeWorks · Ontario, Canada

- Led the team maintaining an ASP.NET MVC C# application; established a technical-debt backlog to protect velocity.
- Standardized client-specific deployments across internal environments; version-controlled deployment scripts and wrote PowerShell tooling for local environments.
- Facilitated codebase handoff to another team; owned dependency upgrades, sequential T-SQL script execution, and security compliance direction.

Software Development Team Lead

Jun 2019 – May 2021

Ontario Health · Toronto, ON

- Led senior developers, QA, and test engineers across two teams owning mission-critical hospital systems (an emergency triage application and a renal reporting system) used across Ontario hospitals.
- During COVID-19, led development of an API to track infection data and enhanced the triage application to support pandemic demand.
- Operated a highly available Azure application (Functions, SQL Managed Instance, Service Bus); improved uptime with deployment slots and Application Insights instrumentation.
- Migrated version control from TFVC to Git and built an automated CI/CD pipeline on Azure DevOps; set technical direction for cloud migration of the legacy reporting application.
- Hired senior developers; improved code review, technical discussions, and automated UI testing; led back-end modernization (dependency injection, SOLID refactoring).

Software Developer

Jan 2016 – Jun 2019

Ceridian HCM · Toronto, ON

- Redesigned the Recruitment module; built an Indeed job-posting integration via REST, a resume converter on Azure Functions, and Google Analytics tracking for the external job board.
- Found and fixed XSS and SQL transaction vulnerabilities and critical Workflow Management System issues; increased unit-test coverage.
- Developed a code generator to migrate legacy code to HTML; selected for a Platform team job rotation.

Earlier roles

2012 – 2015

Software Developer · Workopolis, Toronto, ON

Oct 2014 – Nov 2015

Software Engineer · Method Integration, Toronto, ON

Mar 2014 – Oct 2014

Software Engineer · Ficstar Software, Markham, ON

Nov 2013 – Jan 2014

Software Engineer · Gryphtech, Toronto, ON

Jul 2013 – Nov 2013

Software Engineer · Peto MacCallum Ltd., Toronto, ON

Apr 2012 – Sep 2012

SKILLS

Leadership: Team building, Hiring & onboarding, Performance management, Career development, Roadmap & headcount planning, Vendor cost management, Agile / Scrum, Executive & cross-functional stakeholder management, Distributed teams, JIRA, Smartsheet

Languages: C#, TypeScript, JavaScript, T-SQL, PowerShell, Python, C/C++

Cloud & platforms: Azure Functions, Azure App Services, Azure Service Bus, Azure Event Hubs, Azure SQL Managed Instance, GCP, AWS, Kafka, Docker, Kubernetes

Frameworks: .NET Core, ASP.NET MVC, Node.js, Angular

Data: MSSQL, MySQL, Cosmos DB, MongoDB

DevOps: Azure DevOps, GitHub, Jenkins, Octopus, Bamboo, Bitbucket, Terraform, Cake, Gulp

Observability & security: Datadog, ELK, Grafana, Application Insights, Snyk, SonarQube, WhiteSource

AI tooling: GitHub Copilot, Devin, Claude, ChatGPT

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology, Software Development (BTech)

Seneca Polytechnic (formerly Seneca College) · Toronto, ON

Sep 2008 – Oct 2013